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Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

PROTECT YOUR DATA

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Rapid storage growth across the enterprise, both inside and outside the datacenter and new business requirements, are straining traditional data protection approaches. New disk-based backup technologies can be an effective tool for next generation data protection.

Coping With A Sea Of Data

Enterprise backup policies haven't evolved all that much in recent years. Backup data is still, for the most part, written to magnetic tape each night, duplicated and then sent off-site to meet disaster recovery needs. Of course, disk already plays a role in enterprise data protection—either by providing a temporary stage for data, before it goes to tape, or by supporting snapshots related data protection—but most data still goes to tape.

As more companies move to 24x7 business cycles, and as the amount of data to protect grows rapidly, the notion of a long period of “downtime” for applications and corporate systems appears almost quaint. New disk-based backup technologies can help companies address the backup challenges that come with rapid storage growth and increased recovery expectations, but companies should also expect to use a combination of disk-based technologies.

Front-end storage growth, regulatory compliance, and increasing data retention times have created a need for backup innovation to maintain the highest levels of data protection. Enterprises assessing their data protection infrastructure would do well to begin by asking the following questions:

How much money is spent to protect different types of data and whether or not the most important data has the highest level of protection?

How quickly can you recover different applica-

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tions as well as data in the event of human error, system failure, or disaster?

Is data at your remote offices protected consistently?

Do you frequently test data recovery as well as your state of disaster recovery readiness?

Can you quickly retrieve data such as files or e-mail from online and offline sources in audit situations or recovery emergencies?

Can you effectively demonstrate and report on protected data across business units, locations and applications?

While few organisations can answer all of these questions affirmatively, too many negative or ambiguous responses present a strong argument for revising your data protection infrastructure and policies and considering data deduplication technology.

Flexibility From The Remote Office To The Datacenter

Data deduplication technology is being deployed in both the remote office and in the datacenter to help companies centralise their backup data, reduce storage costs, and improve both local and disaster recovery efficiency. Data deduplication eliminates redundant backup data at a block level across multiple backup sets and locations making file names, attributes, and physical locations irrelevant.

It can function at the start of the backup process, before data ever leaves the server, to reduce the network bandwidth required, or it can be deployed behind a backup application, as a disk-based storage target. Both approaches can offer storage efficiencies that range from 10-50 times and even greater bandwidth savings.

Where and how to deploy data deduplication technology will depend on the user's environment and recovery needs. With client-side dedu-